BRAND IDENTITY PACKAGING ARCHITECTURE ART DIRECTION

NOCTURNE

CLIENT
Nocturne Parfums Paris

YEAR
2026

ROLE
Lead Identity & Packaging Designer

DURATION
8 Weeks

TOOLS & DISCIPLINE
Photoshop, InDesign, Illustrator, 3D Render

01 / PERSPECTIVE

PROJECT OVERVIEW

> "Distilling the atmospheric allure of midnight botanical extraction into an uncompromising, tactile visual identity and monolithic packaging suite."

THE CHALLENGE

Nocturne required a monolithic visual identity system that stood defiantly apart from traditional ornate perfumery. The challenge was to communicate rare nocturnal florals, dark minerality, and luxury restraint without succumbing to generic minimalism or fleeting trends.

THE STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE

Develop a rigorous typographic identity, custom glass bottle silhouettes, bespoke tactile packaging specifications in matte frosted black glass, and heavy archival cotton stocks with blind debossed stamps.

02 / METHODOLOGY

DESIGN PROCESS

PHASE 01 WEEK 01–02

DISCOVERY & BOTANICAL RESEARCH

Conducted comprehensive visual auditing across European fragrance houses and 19th-century botanical apothecary archives. Analyzed raw ingredient palettes—vetiver, black amber, night-blooming jasmine—to build a sensory moodboard rooted in stark contrasts and geological textures.

— Visual competitive matrix of 24 independent fragrance brands
— Material sourcing: FSC-certified unbleached French cotton cardstocks
— Formulated core creative thesis: "Heavyweight Monolithism"

PHASE 02 WEEK 03–04

TYPOGRAPHY & GEOMETRIC SYSTEM

Developed an ultra-extended wordmark featuring razor-sharp structural terminals and balanced optical kerning. Established an editorial grid layout inspired by mid-century Swiss publishing, combining high-contrast serifs with razor-clean grotesque details.

— Bespoke logotype drawing with custom "N" and "R" ligatures
— Dual typographic hierarchy: Architectural Grotesque & Archival Serif
— Comprehensive design token guide across print and digital media

PHASE 03 WEEK 05–06

TACTILE MATERIALITY & PACKAGING

Engineered physical dielines and vessel silhouettes. Specified matte jet-black frosted glass cylinders paired with weighted gunmetal caps. Designed secondary packaging consisting of a rigid two-piece shoulder box with deep blind debossing and micro-engraved foil seal.

— Precision 1:1 scale dieline drafting and folding mockups
— Hot foil stamp testing on 420 GSM tactile charcoal cotton stock
— Custom tamper-evident holographic seal numbering system

PHASE 04 WEEK 07–08

REFINEMENT & PRODUCTION SPECS

Created complete production-ready prepress files, pantone spot color matching guides, and an 80-page brand guidelines binder. Formulated digital campaign visual direction, studio lighting blueprints, and exhibition art direction.

— Pre-press CMYK + 2 Spot Color separation guidelines
— Digital art direction guide for e-commerce and editorial showcases
— Final prototype presentation deck delivered to client leadership

03 / ARTIFACTS

FINAL DELIVERABLES

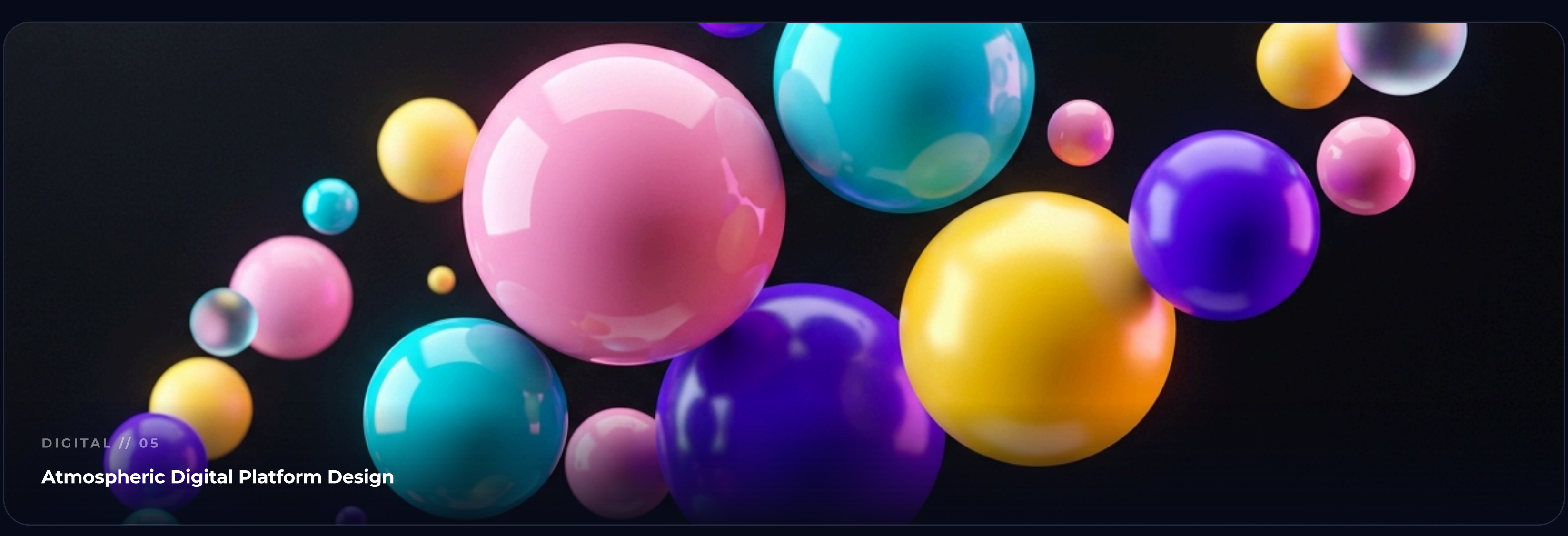
PRIMARY EXHIBIT // 01
Monolithic Fragrance Vessel & Outer Packaging Architecture

NOCTURNE
NOCTURNE
REVITALIZING SERUM
NOCTURNE
NIGHT ELIXIR

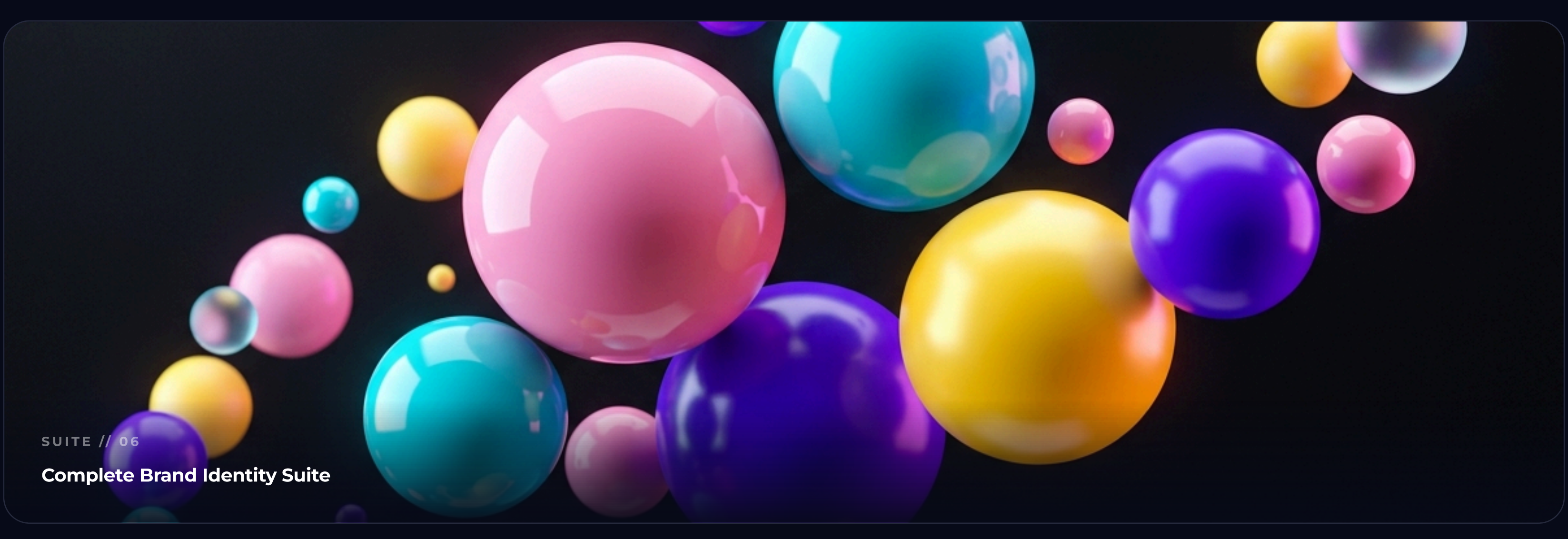
SPECIFICATION // 02
Bespoke Typographic Specimen & Spatial Grid System

MATERIAL STUDY // 03
Matte Frosted Glass, Blind Deboss & Archival Cotton Stock

DETAIL // 04
Embossed Foil Medallion & Seal



DIGITAL // 05
Atmospheric Digital Platform Design



SUITE // 06
Complete Brand Identity Suite

PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY ARCHIVE

NOCTURNE • 2026

DREXEL UNIVERSITY • LOGAN O'NEILL